

zombie will then inform a central unit of its existence, and the central unit will command the zombie to send a low volume of spam. This allows spammers to send high volumes of e-mail without being caught by their ISPs or being tracked down by anti-spammers; a low volume of spam is instead sent from many locations simultaneously.

With stricter legislation being enforced to combat the nuisance of spam, spammers are going to great lengths to conceal the origin of their messages. They do this by spoofing e-mail addresses. In spoofing, the spammer modifies the message so that it looks as if it is coming from another e-mail address. On the other hand, a lot of spammers make their mails easily identifiable as spam. Who would have a name like “ChewTheCigar”, or some such arbitrary word string?

Spammers also use a lot of tricks to circumvent the filter settings. One of the most common tricks is to intentionally misspell common spam filter trigger words. For example, “gambling” might be spelt as “gamblin”, or symbols may be inserted into the word, as in “g/a/m/b/l/i/n/g”.

Other major sources of spam are pornographic Web sites, online pharmacies and casinos. These spammers employ spam rings and make a great deal of money by spamming people’s inboxes. One of the biggest concerns with regards to spamming, apart from the threat to privacy, is the huge waste of bandwidth due to the junk e-mailing. Since it costs next to nothing to send an e-mail, even a small number of spammers can saturate the Internet with junk mail. As with any crime, here too, the spammers are a step ahead of your enforcement agencies and ISPs, coming up with newer methods of exploiting the loopholes.

To curb this nuisance, it is best to report any spam to your ISP and be cautious about putting up your e-mail address on a Web site. If you must give out your e-mail, it is prudent to make sure that the site has adequate privacy measures in place.